



Club Sponsorship

Rochester Institute of Technology

Why Sponsor RITSEC?

RITSEC connects sponsors with a pipeline of highly motivated students through a wide variety of sponsorship opportunities, giving your organization meaningful recruiting access at competitions, career fairs, and other exclusive events. Beyond hiring, sponsorship offers a powerful platform to introduce your tools and services early to future cybersecurity leaders and decision-makers.

What is RITSEC?

RITSEC is a student organization at the Rochester Institute of Technology (RIT). RIT and its affiliates are 501(c)(3) tax-exempt charitable organizations. We are dedicated to upholding “Security Through Community” by educating and preparing RIT students for the cybersecurity field.

We believe computing security belongs to everyone. RITSEC is built to reflect that, ranging from specialized interest groups to research and mentorship programs, and nationally recognized student-run competitions, so that members can explore, grow, and connect in ways that best prepare them for the industry.

By the Numbers

250+

Active Members

25+

Years Running

200+

Alumni

1,500+

Annual
Competition
Participants

🔒 Interest Groups Overview

Vulnerability Research

OT Security

Wireless

Red Team

Incident Response

Physical Security

Reversing

RVAPT

Team Contagion

Operations

WiCyS

Zero-To-Hero

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Section 1

Sponsorship

1.1 Sponsorship Tiers

Tier	Amount	Term
Educational	Non-Monetary	Full Year
Silver	\$1,000+	One Semester
Gold	\$2,000+	Full Year
Platinum	\$5,000+	Full Year
Diamond	\$10,000+	Full Year
Titanium	\$20,000+	Full Year

	Silver \$1,000+	Gold \$2,000+	Platinum \$5,000+	Diamond \$10,000+	Titanium \$20,000+
Events - Get a booth and network at these events					
Career Fair Eve					
Sponsored Hack Night					
IRSeC or ISTS Table					
IRSeC and ISTS Table					
Exclusive Sponsor Event					
Perks - Get some fancy perks with your sponsorship					
Club Talks					
Featured Company Logo					
Competition Inject					
RITSEC Newsletter					
Sponsored Research Grant					
Member Resume Booklet					
ISTS Red Teamer					
IRSeC Red Teamer					
IRSeC Keynote					
Clubroom Plaque					
ISTS Keynote					
Company & RITSEC Merch Line					
All sponsors will be notified of any changes to these benefits.					

1.2 Non-Monetary Sponsorship Benefits

Educational sponsors support the club by contributing resources that directly improve students' technical development and cybersecurity education. These contributions may include presentations/workshops, subscriptions, certification vouchers, software licenses, discounts, or other educational resources relevant to the cybersecurity field. Educational sponsors are assigned to the monetary tier corresponding to the donation value of their contributions to the club, if a donation value can be assigned. Regardless of value, Educational sponsors are entitled to the following benefits:

- Virtual Career Fair Eve
- RITSEC Newsletter
- Company Logo on Website and Competition Shirts
- Club Talks

Educational sponsors are an important part of the RITSEC community, and we are grateful for your support. If you would like to support RITSEC via our non-monetary sponsorship tier, you can do so by speaking at one of our General Meetings or Interest Group meetings, writing a CTF challenge for one of our competitions, or many other opportunities to get involved.

1.3 Monetary Sponsorship Benefits

Sponsorship tiers include all benefits from every preceding tier, plus the new benefits listed at that level. For example, Titanium tier is also able to utilize the “Exclusive Sponsor Event” benefit, though it is only explicitly written in the Diamond tier. More information is available upon request for any of the benefits at each sponsorship tier. If you believe your organization doesn't quite fit a standard sponsorship tier or you're interested in a benefit not listed, we are happy to work with you. Please feel free to reach out with any questions.



Company & RITSEC Merch Line

Titanium sponsors may request a custom co-branded limited edition merchandise line, such as shirts, sweatshirts, and hats featuring both the RITSEC and sponsor logo. Distributed free to all club members, this is a unique opportunity to keep your brand visible across the cybersecurity community.

Clubroom Plaque

Our club has a dedicated room on the second floor of RIT's Global Cybersecurity Institute that attracts dozens of students, members and prospective members daily. For all Titanium sponsors, the club will present a metal plaque and hang it near the door in recognition of your support and for all members and visitors to see.

ISTS Keynote Presentation

Each year, ISTS brings together roughly 175 competitors and competition staff from 17 universities for a keynote address that opens the competition. As a Titanium sponsor, you'll have the opportunity to put your organization on that stage to present on a relevant topic of your choice – in coordination with our Competition Architect – in front of an engaged, diverse audience of emerging cybersecurity talent.

DIAMOND

Exclusive Sponsor Event

Once a year, you are invited to host a private event for RITSEC club members, such as a CTF, recruiting event, workshop, or something else entirely. The event format is fully up to you, while the RITSEC executive board will handle all facility reservations at RIT. These exclusive events often receive publicity from RIT and/or the Global Cybersecurity Institute, helping to draw in additional students interested in the sponsoring company.

IRSeC Keynote Presentation

Each year, IRSeC brings together RITSEC's own members for a student-run red-vs-blue competition, where upperclassmen build and attack the infrastructure while underclassmen compete in teams to defend it. As a sponsor, you'll have the opportunity to deliver the keynote address that opens the competition (approximately forty minutes) to present on a relevant topic of your choice, in front of one of the most concentrated audiences of emerging security talent at RIT.

Participate in IRSeC Red Team

Sponsors are invited to join the Red Team for IRSeC, our internal incident response competition. A majority of IRSeC competitors are eager to explore the field and internship opportunities, making this an ideal touchpoint to build relationships with promising students early in their academic journey.

PLATINUM

Participate in ISTS Red Team

As one of the oldest and largest student-run cybersecurity competitions in the country, ISTS draws a growing population of competitors from across the nation each year. Platinum sponsors are invited to place representatives on the Red Team (with approval from the ISTS Red Team Chief), providing direct, hands-on engagement with both the students competing in the event and those working on it behind the scenes.

Member Resume Booklet

Sponsors are provided a convenient booklet of resumes from RITSEC members actively pursuing employment opportunities. This resource allows your recruiting team to identify candidates at your own pace, opening the door to interviews and outreach year-round, not just during Career Fair Eve.

Company Table at IRSeC and ISTS

As a Platinum sponsor, you are invited to table outside the competition room at all of our competitions. At this table, you have the option to create challenges that earn students points within the competition, or simply use the opportunity to network with the students. Through the combination of these two tabling opportunities, you can expect to meet 150 RIT students and 80 additional students from 16 other universities at a hands-on recruiting environment unlike any other.



Company Table at IRSeC or ISTS

As a Gold sponsor, you are invited to a table outside the competition room at your choice between one of our semesterly competitions. At this table, you have the option to create challenges that earn students points within the competition, or simply to use the opportunity to network with the students throughout the day. At IRSeC, you can expect to meet 100 RIT students, and at ISTS, you can expect to meet 70 RIT students and 80 additional students from 16 other universities.

Sponsored Research Grant

Each year, RITSEC allocates a dedicated research budget that members can apply to utilize for independent cybersecurity projects. As a Gold sponsor, you have the privilege of having at least one research grant per year named in your company's honor. For sponsors who wish to go further, we will work with you to develop a curated list of research topics relevant to your company's focus area. Students who choose from this list will pursue projects that directly build the skills you hire for. We are happy to draft this topic list on your behalf or collaborate with your team to develop it. Upon completion, all grant recipients present their research during the Research portion of our weekly general meetings or at a security conference, giving your company ongoing visibility alongside the work your sponsorship made possible.

Sponsored Hack Night

Hack nights are hands-on technical sessions where RITSEC members work on research projects, practice offensive and defensive security skills, and learn other various cybersecurity passions in a more relaxed, informal setting. As a Gold sponsor, you will have the opportunity to support one of these events, which will be advertised as a "*RITSEC Hack Night Sponsored By [your company]*" and engage directly with members participating in these sessions.

SILVER

The silver tier of sponsorship was created for prospective sponsors to start an engagement with the club and view the level of security professionals we have to offer.

Career Fair Eve

Every semester the night before the larger RIT career fair, RITSEC hosts a sponsor-only career fair event. All sponsors are invited and encouraged to set up a recruiting table at the event. You can read more in **1.4 Career Fair Eve**.

RITSEC Newsletter

Each semester, receive our sponsor newsletter featuring the latest club events, member accomplishments, and ongoing research initiatives.

Competition Inject

IRSeC and ISTS both feature scored business tasks known as injects, such as adding users, configuring firewall rules, or identifying and reporting on vulnerabilities. Your company can design one of these injects and submit it at least one month before the competition. This is a unique opportunity to play a hands-on role in one of our competitions.

Club Talks

Every Friday during our general meeting, the two-hour research portion gives members, master's and PhD students, and sponsors the opportunity to present on cybersecurity topics of their choosing. All talks are live streamed and archived on the RITSEC YouTube channel.

Featured Company Logo

Get your company logo placed on the RITSEC website and any club-distributed competition event shirts, such as IRSeC and ISTS.

1.4 Career Fair Eve

During both fall and spring semesters, RITSEC hosts a member-exclusive career fair with all club sponsors the Monday and Tuesday before the RIT career fair. The Monday event is hosted on Zoom for all sponsors who can not attend the Tuesday club career fair in person. The Tuesday event is hosted in the Global Cybersecurity Institute conference rooms, where each sponsor receives a table for recruitment.

This event is beneficial to sponsors because the RIT co-op requirement drives students toward a focus on hands-on experience with vulnerability research, cloud computing, incident response, red teaming, teamwork, and project management. Club members receive this experience specifically from working with club assets and attending events funded by our sponsors, ultimately creating the highest quality applicants.

Sponsors receive early access to club member submitted resumes and nearly 200 in-person cybersecurity-oriented attendees before the larger career fair.



Students Lining Up During Career Fair Eve

Section 2

Competitions

2.1 Incident Response Security Competition (IRSeC)

IRSeC is our beginner-friendly competition that focuses on the basics of network defense and incident response. The environment exposes competitors to technologies commonly found in industry, while giving them the opportunity to learn. They will be asked to keep business critical services up and available. Competitors will also be asked to complete various assignments and tasks, called injects, which are similar to day-to-day business tasks. While handling these aspects, the student-led RITSEC Red Team attacks the competing teams to simulate threat actors. The competition is designed to teach the fundamental concepts of incident response in a fun, hands-on manner.

Sponsors of tiers Gold and up are encouraged to set up booths at IRSeC and recruit RIT security professionals.



IRSeC 2025 Group Photo

2.2 RITSEC CTF

The RITSEC CTF (Capture the Flag) is a Jeopardy-style competition hosted online for sixty hours in the late spring. Participation is open to teams internationally. The CTF generally focuses on binary exploitation, reverse engineering, cryptography, forensics, programming, and web security challenges. We welcome all skill levels!

2.3 Information Security Talent Search (ISTS)

ISTS is an annual three-day competition hosted in the early spring at RIT. Every year, competitors from RIT and 17 colleges around the country are faced with a wide variety of challenges which are designed to cover many facets of the security industry. This includes defensive and offensive capabilities, system administration, software security, networking, programming, and much more! Challenges and activities include a thematic physical security game, Capture the Flag (CTF), King-of-the-Hill (KoTH), policy writing, incident response, and code review. They must do this all while defending a completely student-built infrastructure. Many collegiate teams are invited back from previous years but there is now an opportunity for new teams to compete in a qualifier to earn a spot at ISTS.

Sponsors of tiers Gold and up are encouraged to set up booths at ISTS and recruit young security professionals.



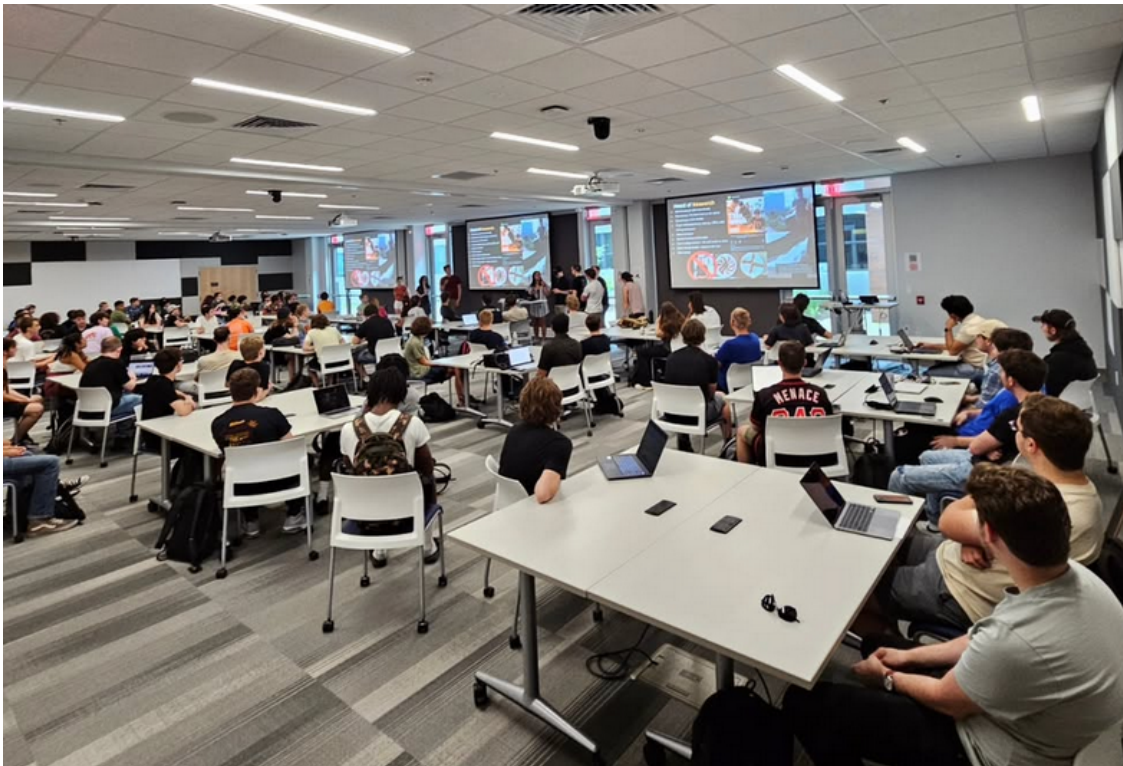
Group Photo ISTS 2026

Section 3

General Meetings

3.1 Education

The first half of our weekly meetings (from 12:00pm to 1:00pm Eastern Time) are for Education where a student or guest speaker gives an hour long presentation where they introduce a security related topic. The speaker is typically well-versed in the topic and provides a unique perspective on the subject. These subjects can range from Blue Teaming topics such as *Intro to Linux* and *Intro to Windows* to more in-depth topics such as *Binary Exploitation/Reversing* and *Wireless/Hardware Security*.



Education Meeting

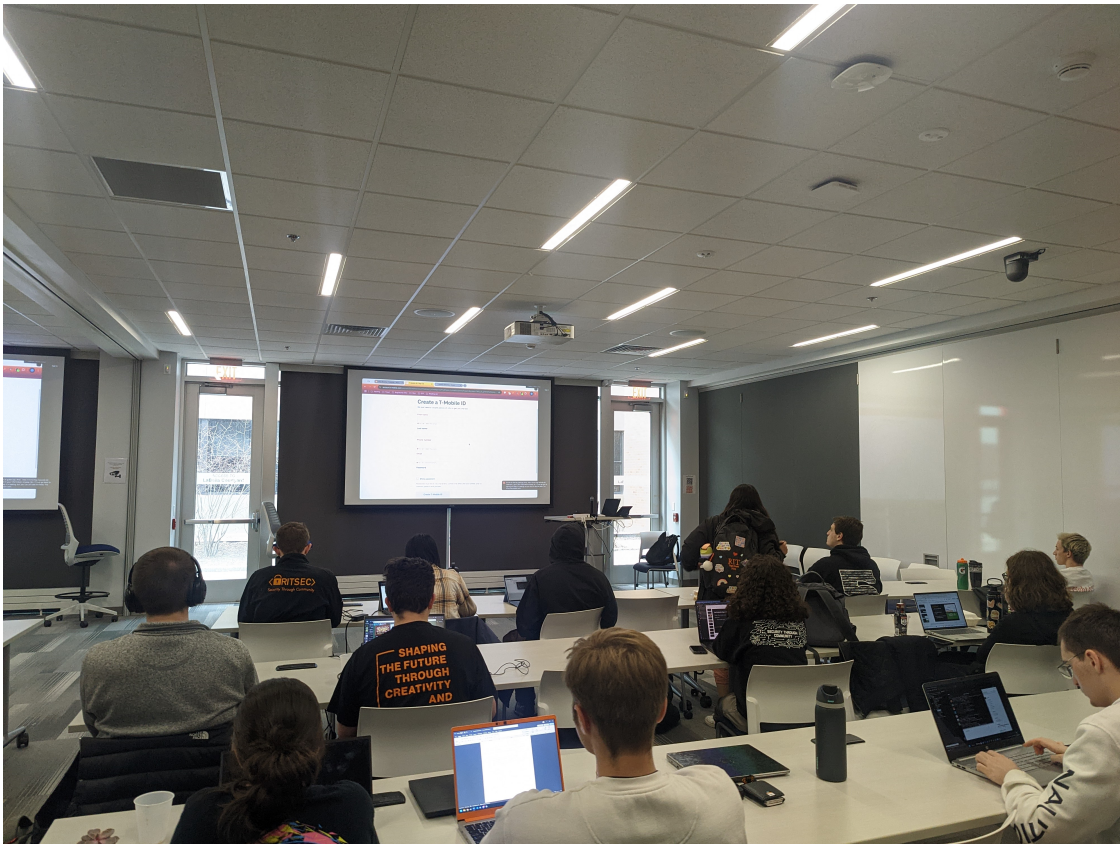
3.2 Demos

Weekly demonstrations (demos) are the members' chance to get hands-on experience learning the education topic from that week. Structured as a year-long capture the flag (CTF) competition, members tackle new challenges every Friday across three difficulty levels. Easy demos can be solved just by following to the week's Education presentation, while hard demos involve additional research and creativity to solve. This structure is set up to reinforce critical thinking and problem-solving skills. The top 3 scorers at the end of the school year win prizes.

Weekly demos give members hands-on practice with that week's education topic. Structured like a year-long CTF, five new challenges drop every Friday across three tiers — easy, medium, and hard. Easy demos can be solved just by following the week's topic, while hard ones require research and ingenuity, reinforcing critical-thinking and problem-solving skills. The top 3 scorers at year's end win prizes.

3.3 Research

Many of our members work on personal projects and security research during the academic year. RITSEC's Research section—the second portion of our weekly meeting (2:00pm to 4:00pm Eastern Time)—is where members present their research. There are usually three or four presenters each week. This section allows for club discourse and helps get other members interested in doing projects outside of class. We also offer grants for our members, allowing them to request funding for paid services. This helps our members create amazing presentations!



Industry Presenter From BugCrowd During Research Meeting

Section 4

Competition Teams

4.1 Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition (CCDC) Team

The CCDC team participates in a competition that simulates real-world cybersecurity scenarios. As a blue team, their role is to manage and defend the IT infrastructure of a mock business, working to maintain critical service availability, respond to business needs, and identify and remediate live cyberattacks from a professional red team.

As part of their recruitment efforts, the team holds weekly tryout sessions each fall semester to educate aspiring members and identify new talent. Tryouts conclude with a “CCDC Mini Comp” run by club members to evaluate cyber defense skills in potential new team members. Open to all students in RITSEC, this competition is a great opportunity to gain experience and sharpen blue team skills.

Our team has placed top 3 in the Northeast region for the past 5 years.



NECCDC Regionals 2026

4.2 Collegiate Penetration Testing Team (CPTC)

The club's premier penetration testing team. The students that compete on our CPTC team learn known vulnerabilities in Active Directory, Windows, and Linux and how to exploit them. In competitions, these students break into competition architecture that simulates enterprise ecosystems as well as write comprehensive remediation and compliance reports.

Our team won the global competition in 2021 and placed 3rd in 2024.



Global CPTC 2024

Section 5

Interest Groups & Partnerships

5.1 WiCyS Student Chapter

The Women in Cybersecurity Student Chapter at RIT is an inclusive organization dedicated to making RIT's cybersecurity community an encouraging environment for female students. The chapter, part of a larger global community, holds meetings and events for students to share their passion for security while also creating a supportive network within RITSEC.

5.2 Operations Program & Ops Interest Group

The Ops Program is responsible for supporting our physical servers and private cloud infrastructure that is used for competitions, weekly Capture the Flag challenges, and other club programs. Members learn the inner workings of topics like software-defined networking, infrastructure-as-code, and datacenter hardware configuration, all on cloud-scale infrastructure. At the Ops Interest Group, Senior Ops members present on concepts relevant to infrastructure deployments and hosted services.

5.3 RITSEC Red Team & Red Team Recruiting

The RITSEC Red Team is a selective group of students who develop and deploy custom offensive tooling against blue teams at RITSEC competitions and beyond. Members grow their skills across red teaming, software development, and offensive security engineering while performing the role of an effective adversary in realistic competition environments. Prospective members are encouraged to attend Red Team Recruiting, where they can learn about the requirements to join, get an introduction to red teaming concepts, and begin building their first red team tool.

5.4 Team Contagion

Contagion represents RITSEC in a variety of Capture the Flag (CTF) competitions. Members learn about different challenge categories and apply that knowledge by competing in CTFs ranging in levels of difficulty on the local, national, and international level. Additionally, the team creates their own challenges for the annual RITSEC CTF, WiCyS CTF, and ISTS CTF.

5.5 Wireless

The Wireless Interest Group focuses on securing and attacking wireless concepts and protocols such as WiFi, Bluetooth, RF, cellular, and more. Through the interest group, students hear presentations from senior members of the club, industry alumni, RIT professors and graduate and Ph.D. students.

5.6 Incident Response

The Incident Response Interest group is focused on all things Incident Response. The group specifically targets incident response in a corporate environment but covers both technical and non-technical aspects of Incident Response, such as SOC, threat hunting, alerts and monitoring, data privacy, forensics, GRC, and blue team scripting.

5.7 Reversing

The Reverse Engineering (or reversing) Interest Group revolves around the in-depth knowledge of binary applications and ultimately reverse engineering malware. Topics such as assembly, executable formats, malware tactics, and much more are covered throughout the semester.

5.8 Physical Security

In the Physical Security Interest Group, members will learn all the basics of the world outside of the computer. They gain experience picking locks, using alternative entry methods, social engineering, and leveraging open-source intelligence. This group teaches students useful skills that are not typically covered in the classroom.

5.9 RVAPT

At RITSEC's Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing Interest Group, members learn how to find and exploit vulnerabilities in networks and associated services via hands-on, custom labs. Each week, they learn one to two ways to break into a network and keep building upon it throughout the semester.

5.10 OT Security

The Operational Technology Security Interest Group focuses on learning how to protect computers and machines that control real-world systems, such as power plants, water treatment facilities, traffic lights, and manufacturing processes. Recent projects and research initiatives of the group include detection engineering, ICS protocol analysis, OT attack analysis, and adversarial emulation.

5.11 Vulnerability Research

The Vulnerability Research Interest Group focuses on introducing club members to vulnerability and security research concepts. This includes concepts such as bug bounty, code analysis, and fuzzing. Recent projects and research initiatives of the group include a mini-competition for modern memory allocation implementations, n-day analysis, and agentic fuzzing.

5.12 Zero-To-Hero

The Zero-to-Hero Interest Group is a launchpad for students taking their first steps in cybersecurity. Intended as an approachable way to help club members starting out on their cybersecurity journey, ZTHIG helps build the technical foundation they need to go above and beyond in their careers. Members learn cybersecurity fundamentals, build personal projects, and dive into their new favorite security niche.

Section 6

Activities

6.1 Mentorship Program

Open to all students, RITSEC's mentorship program pairs more experienced upperclassmen with beginner students, having them work side-by-side on security projects. Forming connections between mentors and mentees fosters the environment of learning and productivity RITSEC strives to have every day, and creates the highest quality students. Upon completion, all mentorship project groups present their experience and findings to the club during the research portion of general meetings.

Some examples of recent mentorship topics have been:

- Freshie's First SIEM: Work through Splunk's College and Workforce training program and prepare for the Splunk Core Certified User exam.
- Ducks in the Wild: Learn how to develop and use a "Bad USB," commonly known as a USB Rubber Ducky, to both attack and defend a computer.
- Networking Essentials: Students learn how to set up and secure networks for defense, and then flip the script by using networking skills in red team scenarios. This mentorship equips students with the knowledge to take control of any network environment.
- Wardriving: Involves creating, typically in a hard-shell carry case, a wireless packet sniffing device that contains location data to then map networks anywhere it passes by. This group developed a wardriving carry case that can be brought around campus to learn more about hands-on wireless security.
- 404 Found Us: Learn and develop a fundamental understanding of how web applications are built, how to spot vulnerabilities in them, and how to recommend mitigations.

6.2 Conferences

We also provide resources to our members to attend and network at popular security conferences. For example, our main conference of the year was ShmooCon, a large east- coast hacker convention hosted in Washington, D.C. that ran from 2005 to 2025. For this event, we ran our own Shmooze-a-Member program to pay for members who did not receive ShmooCon's Shmooze-a-Student scholarship. Additionally, our WiCyS chapter pays for members to attend the Rochester Security Summit. Our board is currently seeking conferences that will have similar engagement opportunities for companies in the near future.



ShmooCon 2025

Our WiCyS student chapter also attends the Women in Cybersecurity conference annually. These students in our WiCyS chapter are well equipped to properly engage with industry professionals and gain more from attending these conferences because of the intersectional experiences they have from both RITSEC and WiCyS RIT.



WiCyS Conference 2026

Section 7

Contact and Socials

7.1 Contact Us

7.1.1 RIT Advancement

For additional questions about RIT's gift process and invoice creation.

- **Katey Sackett**
Assistant Director of Corporate and Foundation Relations
`kxsuadv@rit.edu`

7.1.2 RITSEC

For any additional questions about club operations, events, etc.

- **Executive Board**
`eboard@ritsec.club`
 - **Lucas Brown**
Director of Public Relations
`publicrelations@ritsec.club` / `ldb1970@rit.edu`
 - **Leah Kvares**
President
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 - **Lukasz Ozimek**
Vice President
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 - **Jake Miksiewicz**
Treasurer
`treasurer@ritsec.club` / `jam4156@rit.edu`
-

7.2 Find Us Online

- **Website**
<https://www.ritsec.club/>
- **Twitch (Weekly Meetings, Fridays 12-4PM EST)**
<https://www.twitch.tv/ritsec>
- **YouTube (Archived Talks and Livestream)**
<https://www.youtube.com/c/RITSEC>